CURRICULUM VITAE

Yang Yan (燕阳)

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ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor (4/2026–), School of Political Science and International Relations, Tongji University, Shanghai, China.

Postdoctoral Researcher (11/2023–2/2026), Institute for Chinese Studies, Freie Universität Berlin, Berlin, Germany.

-Advisor: Prof. Dr. Genia Kostka

Postdoctoral Fellow (10/2021–10/2023), School of Public Policy & Management, Tsinghua University, Beijing, China.

-Advisor: Prof. Angang Hu

Research Associate (10/2021–10/2023), Institute for Contemporary China Studies, Tsinghua University, Beijing, China.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Management Science and Engineering, School of Economics and Management, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunication (BUPT), China, 6/2021.

-Thesis: *Policy Agenda Setting and the Environmental Governance Performance*

-Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Chunhui Yuan

-Grade: 94/100 (A-); recognized as an Excellent Doctoral Dissertation of the BUPT

B.A., Public Administration, School of Economics and Management, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunication (BUPT), China, 6/2015.

-Thesis: *The History and Causes of Economic Fluctuations in Germany since the 1970s*

-Grade: 92/100 (Excellent)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Research field: Comparative Politics (China Politics); Public Administration and Public Policy.

My research focuses on **elite and bureaucratic politics, political communication and propaganda, issue attention, and digital governance.** I am currently building a database of publicly reported meetings involving provincial leaders in China, which I use to study official-business networks, digital state-business alliances, and local diplomatic networks. I am also conducting survey research on how generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) is influencing policy processes and bureaucratic behavior at the grassroots level in China.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- **Yan, Y.**, & Yang, Z.* (2025). Portraying Competence, Benevolence or Party Loyalty? Political Propaganda and the Image Building of Political Elites in China. ***Comparative Politics.*** 57(4), 529–550. https://doi.org/10.5129/001041525X17380761641486

- Yang, Z., **Yan, Y.***, & Xu, H. (2024). Towards "All-round Cadres": Policy Priorities and Issue Diversity of Local Bureaucrats in China, 2005–19. ***China: An International Journal***, 22(1), 1–24. https://www.muse.jhu.edu/article/920955

- **Yan, Y.**, Christensen, T., & Yang, Z.* (2024). Personnel Control and Local Officials' Attention to Economic Development: Evidence from China. ***Administration & Society***, 56(2), 145–171. https://doi.org/10.1177/00953997231223518

- **Yan, Y.**, Yang, Z.*, & Yuan, C. (2022). Political Attention in a Single-Leading-Party State: A Comparative Study of the Policy Agenda in China, 2003–2019. ***Journal of Comparative Policy Analysis: Research and Practice***, 24(2), 138–158. https://doi.org/10.1080/13876988.2020.1843020

- **Yan, Y.**, & Yuan, C.* (2020). City Administrative Level and Municipal Party Secretaries' Promotion: Understanding the Logic of Shaping Political Elites in China. ***Journal of Contemporary China***, 29(122), 266–285. https://doi.org/10.1080/10670564.2019.1637570

Peer-Reviewed Chinese Articles

- Yuan, C., & **Yan, Y**. (2020). Central Environmental Inspection: Self-Adaptation of The Pressure Model of Environmental Governance in China <中央环保督察：压力型环境治理模式的自我调适>. *Governance Studies* <治理研究>, 36(1), 57–68. http://doi.org/10.15944/j.cnki.33-1010/d.2020.01.008

- Yang, Z., **Yan, Y.**, Zhang, X., & Zhang, J. (2021). Competence-oriented Cadre Selection of the Chinese Communist Party: Evidence from the Members of Standing Committee of Provincial Party Committee, 1983-2012 <中国共产党干部选任的能力导向——来自省委常委的证据(1983—2012年)>. *CASS Journal of Political Science* <政治学研究>, 3, 26–41.

- **Yan, Y.**, & Yang, Z. (2022). The Failure of Agenda-Setting of Local Government in China <地方领导干部政策注意力配置"失灵"现象及其治理>. *Academia Bimestris* <学海>, 197(05), 128–134. https://doi.org/10.16091/j.cnki.cn32-1308/c.2022.05.007

- **Yan, Y.**, Xian, Y., & Yang, Z. (2022). Issue-based Politics in China's Local Governance: An Analysis from the Perspective of Policy Attention <当代中国地方治理中的议题政治学——基于政策注意力视角的分析>. *Humanities & Social Sciences Journal of Hainan University* <海南大学学报人文社科版>, 41(04), 94–104. https://doi.org/10.15886/j.cnki.hnus.202207.0386

- Huang, J., **Yan, Y.**, Yang, Z. (2024)**.** Cadres' Grassroots Working Experience and Regional Business Environment Construction: An Empirical Study Based on the Resumes of Standing Committee Members of Provincial Party Committees <干部基层工作经历与区域营商环境建设——基于省委常委履历的实证研究>. Journal of Beijing University of Technology (Social Sciences Edition) <北京工业大学学报>, 24(04), 77–89.

Submitted Manuscript and Forthcoming

- **Yan, Y.**, & Kostka, G.* Forthcoming. "Divergent Pathways to Digital China: Unveiling Provincial Digital Agendas Under Top-Level Design." *Journal of Contemporary China*.
- **Yan, Y.**, & Zhusong Yang*. Forthcoming. "Aligning Agendas in Public-Activity Reports: Provincial Leaders and Central Signals in China, 2016–2022." *Journal of Chinese Political Science*.
- **Yan, Y.,** Guo, D., & Kostka, G.* Forthcoming. "Reassurance and Pride: Narrating and Legitimating Digital Surveillance in China." *International Political Science Review*.

Projects in Progress

- From Assistance to Responsibility: Task Structure, Human Control, and Generative AI Use in Chinese Local Government (Collaborated with Zhusong Yang).
- Justifying War, Seeing Leaders: Narrative Frames, Elite Images, and Chinese Attitudes toward the Russia–Ukraine War (Collaborated with Dr. Shengxiang Ji from Shandong University).
- Business Access and Subnational Governance under Authoritarian Multilevel Governance: Evidence from China, 2005–2024 (Collaborated with Dr. María Sol Parrales López from The London School of Economics and Political Science).
- Does awareness of AI-generated misinformation weaken the persuasive effects of political propaganda? (Collaborated with Dr. Yixuan Zhang from Free University Berlin).
- Who Builds the Local Digital State? Provincial Leaders and Digital Business Partnerships in China (Collaborated with Prof. Dr. Genia Kostka from Free University Berlin)
- Policy Agendas and Environmental Protection: How Agenda-Setting Matters. *APSA Preprints*. https://doi.org/10.33774/apsa-2023-8zqlk

Book (in progress)

The Face of Authoritarianism: The Propaganda and Public Image of Chinese Political Elites

Books (in Chinese)

The Regulation of the Express Delivery Industry <快递市场监管>. Co-editor with Chunhui Yuan, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications Press, 2019.

Issue-based Politics of State Governance in Contemporary China <当代中国国家治理的议题政治学>, Co-author with Zhusong Yang, Guangming Daily Press, 2024.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

The State Post Bureau Project, "Feasibility Study on the Construction of Postal Industry Technology R&D Center", team member, 2018.

National Social Science Foundation Project, "Study on the Logic and Incentive Mechanism of Policy Attention of Chinese Government", team member, 2021–2025.

European Research Council, "Digital Governance in China", team member, 2023–2025.

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

121st American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Vancouver, Canada, 9/2025.

PRIVACY-China Workshop, St Antony's College, University of Oxford, UK, 7/2025.

International Conference on China Policy Studies (ICCPS), Beijing Normal University, China, 6/2025.
Annual Conference of the Political Studies Association (PSA), University of Birmingham and Aston University, UK, 4/2025.
German Association for Asian Studies (ASC), Annual Meeting, University of Bonn, Germany, 11/2024.
SCRIPTS Workshop "Sharpening Analytic Instruments of Narrative Contestation During Conflicts", Freie Universität Berlin, Germany, 11/2024.
120th American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, USA, 9/2024.
The European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR), General Conference, University College Dublin, Ireland, 8/2024.
119th American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Los Angles, USA, 8/2023.
American Association for Chinese Studies (AACS), Annual Meeting, Virtual Meeting, 10/2021.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Modern Economic Theory, guest lecturer and teaching assistant for Prof. Chunhui Yuan, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications, 2/2016–6/2016.
The Methodology of Social Science Research, guest lecturer, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications, 3/2022, 3/2023.
LV 14228: Theories and Discourses in Chinese Social Science Studies, guest lecturer, Freie Universität Berlin, 11/2023, 10/2024, 11/2025.

DISSERTATION SUPERVISION

Assisted in supervising the following graduate dissertations:

- Qingyang Li (李清阳), master's in Management, School of Public Policy and Management, Tsinghua University, 2023–2024
- Zhen Yu (喻真), Ph.D. in Management, School of Public Policy and Management, Tsinghua University, 2022–2023
- Jingyi Hua (华静宜), bachelor's in Public Management, School of Public Policy and Management, Tsinghua University, 2022–2023

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Anonymous reviewer: *Administration & Society (A&S); Cambridge Journal of Regions, Economy and Society (CJRES); Environmental Politics; International Political Science Review (IPSR); Journal of Contemporary China (JoCC); Journal of Electronic Business & Digital Economics; Review of Policy Research (RPR)*
Presenter, Academic Talk: *"Policy Agenda-Setting in Comparative Perspective: Theoretical Evolution and Research Frontiers"*, Public Policy Speaker Series (#14), School of Government, Beijing Normal University, 6/2025.
Panel Chair, *"Citizens' Attitudes and Trust in Public Policy"*, The 2nd International Conference on Chinese Public Policy, Beijing (Beijing Normal University), 6/2025.
Discussant, SCRIPTS Paper Workshop: *"Sharpening Analytic Instruments of Narrative Contestation During Conflicts"*, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany, 11/2024.
Panel Chair, *"Pathways to 'Green Policies' and a Greener Future"*, Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association (APSA), Los Angeles, USA, 8/2023.

Moderator, Academic Lecture: *"Contemporary China Studies Overseas: Trends and Developments"*, delivered by Prof. Suisheng Zhao (Josef Korbel School of International Studies, University of Denver), School of Economics and Management, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications, 6/2019.

Panelists, Civil Society 20 (C20) Summit 2017 in Hamburg, Germany, 6/2017.

Internship, Legambiente Environmental Group in Padova, Italy, 6/2017–7/2017.

Internship, China Biodiversity Conservation and Green Development Foundation (CBCGDF), Beijing, 2/2017–5/2017.

Internship, The State Post Bureau, Beijing, 12/2015.

ACADEMIC HONORS

Excellent Doctoral Dissertation of Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications, 6/2021.

LANGUAGE AND SKILLS

Language: Chinese (Native speaker); English (Fluent); Korean (TOPIK: Level 2)

Statistical analysis: SPSS, Stata, R, Python, and NVIVO

DATASETS

- Publicly Reported Meeting Event Database of Chinese Provincial Political Elites (2005–2024)
- Career Database of Political Elites in Chinese Prefecture-level Cities (2001–2019)
- Daily News Reports on Activities of Chinese Provincial Political Elites (2013–2023)
- Policy Agenda Database of Important Meetings of Chinese Central and Provincial Governments (2008–2023)

REFERENCES

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